

2024 年全国大学生英语竞赛初赛题 (A 类)
2024 National English Competition for College Students
(Type A-Preliminary)
(Total: 150 marks Time: 120 minutes)

Part I Listening Comprehension (30 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

In this section, you will hear **five** short conversations. Each conversation will be read only once. At the end of each conversation, one question will be asked, and you'll have fifteen seconds to read the four choices marked A, B, C and D, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the answer sheet with a single line through the centre.

1. A. Read books.
B. Watch TV.
C. Play tennis.
D. Watch movies.
2. A. Downtown.
B. To the park.
C. Uphill.
D. To the train station.
3. A. It was fine.
B. It was windy.
C. It was cloudy.
D. It was wonderful.
4. A. It may rain.
B. She may go for a shower.
C. The man may come see her.
D. The man may go buy an umbrella.
5. A. Because it's close to a restaurant.
B. Because it has a large kitchen.
C. Because the rooms are big.
D. Because his roommate is a chef.

Section B (10 marks)

In this section, you will hear two long conversations. Each conversation will be read only once. At the end of each conversation, there will be a one-minute pause.

Conversation One

Listen to the conversation. Then read the four choices marked A, B, C and D, and decide which is the best answer according to what you hear. Then mark the corresponding letter on the answer sheet with a single line through the centre.

6. What's the main reason why the woman calls the man?
A. To convince him to go on a canoeing trip.
B. To invite him to go for a cookout.
C. To help her set up the camp tents.
D. To ask whether she can borrow his car.
7. What does the man have to take?

- A. Food and drink on the way.
 - B. A bathing suit and a sleeping bag.
 - C. A canoe.
 - D. A tent.
8. What does the man say he enjoys doing?
- A. Diving.
 - B. Driving.
 - C. Sleeping out.
 - D. Rowing canoes
9. Why does the woman need to talk to the man again?
- A. To find out whether he wants to go canoeing.
 - B. To confirm what he is going to take with him.
 - C. To ask him whether his car is repaired.
 - D. To tell him what time they are leaving.
10. When are they leaving?
- A. On Thursday.
 - B. On Friday.
 - C. On Saturday.
 - D. On Sunday.

Conversation Two

Listen to the conversation. Then complete the following sentences with one word according to what you hear. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

- 11. Sarah has always been interested in teaching and wants to gain a teaching ____.
- 12. Sarah can share accommodation with her ____ if she gets the offer of the college.
- 13. The description of the course in the prospectus gave Sarah a very ____ impression.
- 14. Sarah is keen on the idea of learning about teaching ____ being asked to do it.
- 15. A friend who had done this course ____ Sarah about all of the hard work.

Section C (5 marks)

In this section, you will hear five short news items. Each item will be read only once. After each item there will be a fifteen-second pause. During the pause, read the question and the four choices marked A B. C and D, and decide which is the best answer. Then mark the corresponding letter on the answer sheet with, a single line through the centre.

16. When will the weather change?
- A. This morning.
 - B. This afternoon.
 - C. On Monday.
 - D. On Tuesday.
17. What is above the convenience store?
- A. An office.
 - B. A snack bar.
 - C. A place to live.
 - D. A place for equipment.
18. How long will the work on the two elevators take?
- A. One week.

- B. Two weeks.
 - C. One month.
 - D. Two months.
19. What will happen in five minutes?
- A. Passengers for Train number 16 will get on the train.
 - B. Train number 16 will leave for New York.
 - C. Tickets of train number 16 will go on sale.
 - D. The store of train number 16 will be open.
20. What is a requirement for using IEP's services?
- A. Foreign language skills.
 - B. Experience living abroad.
 - C. A science background.
 - D. A college degree.

Section D (10 marks)

In this section, you will hear one monologue. The monologue will be read twice. After listening, answer the questions using no more than five words. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

- 21. What is exported the most now according to the monologue?
- 22. What are traditionally thought to be the leading exports?
- 23. Why has the value of food product exports increased?
- 24. How many hectares have been developed as a special region for the products?
- 25. What kind of fruits and root vegetables are expected to continue to grow?

Part II Vocabulary & Grammar (15 marks)

There are 15 incomplete sentences in this part. For each blank there are four choices marked A, B, C and D, Choose the one that best completes the sentence. Then mark the corresponding letter on the answer sheet with a single line through the centre.

26. If you wish to speak with the director, you have to ____ an appointment first.
- A. call
 - B. invite
 - C. schedule
 - D. receive
27. Both ____ must sign the contract in the presence of a lawyer.
- A. clauses
 - B. parties
 - C. signals
 - D. provisions
28. We ____ each staff member to do his or her part to get this project completed on time.
- A. expect
 - B. explore
 - C. expend
 - D. expedite
29. Time is short and we will have to work very hard to ____ our goals by the end of the year.
- A. perceive
 - B. retrieve
 - C. conceive

D. achieve

30. There is not much agriculture in this area because the ____ yearly rainfall is so low.

A. available

B. abrupt

C. avaricious

D. average

31. He had a good reputation among his colleagues and was ____ as a very fair boss as well.

A. regarded

B. registered

C. regulated

D. related

32. The clerk ____ the manual ____ the secretary to see if she could figure out how to fix the problem herself.

A. lent; to

B. loaned; on

C. offered; for

D. borrowed; from

33. The director wanted me to let her know how many people ____ for the workshop.

A. showed in

B. showed up

C. showed off

D. showed around

34. The office was in excellent condition when we moved in because the former ____ was very tidy.

A. occupying

B. occupied

C. occupant

D. occupancy

35. ____ Mr Lee works very hard and always meets his deadlines, he still hasn't been given a promotion.

A. Since

B. If

C. Despite

D. Although

36. We moved the company offices last month, and they are now located ____ Oakdale Avenue.

A. at

B. on

C. in

D. to

37. They will receive your application and arrange an interview ____ you have submitted all your paperwork.

A. while

B. prior to

C. as soon as

D. during which

38. —I'm sure we'll have good weather there, anyway, so lots of time for sunbathing on the beach.

—Yes, I think it'll be extremely hot there.

—You're right we'll probably end up wishing we were back in Scotland! We're certainly going to have a varied trip.

—Yes. In Scotland we're probably going to do lots of walking and in Greece we're going to be lying on the beach. ____

A. I think it's going to be a tiring trip.

B. I imagine we'll even get a bit of a tan.

C. Don't worry. I'll call you when necessary.

D. I'm sure it's going to take a long time.

39. —What shall we say about the furniture?

—Well, it's not luxurious but it's very comfortable. _____. Oh, exactly they will need to bring their own lamp; both of the lights in the ceiling are really old and not very bright.

—That's true. But it has got a nice bed.

A. The room has everything you need.

B. It's also got a great view of the garden.

C. It's a great room for working in during the day.

D. They will need to bring their own mirror if they want one.

40. —What has been the most useful thing you've learned so far?

—Learning about the behaviour of dogs on the course has helped me understand my own dog better. Before, if I heard him bark, I just told him to be quiet. _____.

—And what do you hope to do when you've finished?

A. I was thinking about doing another course.

B. But I've decided I'm going to stop studying.

C. I'd really like to work in either a zoo or a park.

D. Now, I stop to think about why he's doing it.

Part III Cloze (10 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in the blanks with the correct forms of 5 words or phrases out of the 7 given in the box. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

affect; carry out; consider, come from; eight; establish; separate from



Noisy neighbours, uncollected litter and graffiti are among the things that really annoy us, according to a new survey. The findings (41) _____ a Mori poll of more than 2,000 residents in three UK cities—London, Dundee and Newcastle.

The government-commissioned, survey revealed that other issues, such as dog mess and abandoned vehicles, also cause so much anxiety that they can affect our quality of life. Designed to measure how people respond to noise, the survey also (42) _____ the extent to which we are troubled by other anti-social problems.

While almost one in three people said noisy neighbours were a problem, they placed it (43)

_____ on a list of what troubled them most. They were more than twice as concerned about litter and rubbish--the main problem to affect their quality of life. They said noise was a problem of similar scale to abandoned cars and drinking in the street. However, the effect of noisy neighbours ranked much more highly among residents already dissatisfied with their home-jumping to second place. It is also the second biggest quality -of-life issue among residents in medium-or high-rise flats. The study—(44) _____ for the Department for Environment, Food and Rural Affairs—found that loud music, shouting and banging attracted far more complaint than noisy parties. As many as two in five people annoyed by noise have complained to their council or the police, while one in four have complained directly to neighbourhood noise as being synonymous with a “lack of (45) _____.

The Environment Minister said tackling noise pollution was a government priority.

Section B (5 marks)

Read the following passage and fill in each blank with one word in one of the following three ways according to the context, by using the correct form of the given word(s), or by using the given letter(s) of the word. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

In recent years, the amount of money earned by top sportsmen and women has risen and attracted a lot of media attention. Stars of high-profile sports such as football, golf, tennis, boxing and motor racing often feature in lists of the world's (46) _____ (rich) people. The objective of this essay is to decide if these sportspeople should receive such large amounts of money.

It is true that not all sports stars are very well paid, but certain individuals do earn an enormous amount. The earnings of these sports stars come from a number of sources. Firstly, there are the huge salaries for some stars, for instance footballers. Secondly, there is the prize money available for winning major sporting competitions and trophies. Finally, and perhaps most lucrative for many top sports stars, are sponsorship deals and advertising contracts.

Many people argue that these stars (47) des_____ their earnings for a number of important reasons. Sports players provide entertainment, like any well-known actor or pop star. They are professional people at the top of their chosen career. In simple terms, they are the best at what they do, and should be paid accordingly. They have put in years of training to be as good as they can be at their sport.



It can also be argued that most sports stars have a (48) _____ (relatives) short career, and so need to earn a lot of money in a short time to support them when they retire. In some sports, there is a risk of serious injury and death. Sportsmen and women should be compensated for this risk.

In contrast, some people argue that it is wrong to pay sports stars these huge amounts of money when there is, so much (49) pov_____ in the world. Sports stars do not save lives or really contribute much to society, apart from providing

entertainment, which can be seen as unnecessary. It is also clear that these sports stars often have extravagant lifestyles, appearing in celebrity magazines and generally not using their wealth in a positive way. Some, even though they are role models for young people, actually behave very badly.

In conclusion, it is obvious that there are differences not only between sports, but also between individuals in the same sports. On (50) _____ it can be said that sports stars are worth the money they earn, as they have the ability to enhance people's lives by their achievements and to unite whole countries during significant competitions.

Part IV Reading Comprehension (30 marks)

There are three passages in this part. Each passage is followed by several questions. Respond to the questions using information from the passage. Remember to write the answers on the answer sheet.

Section A (10 marks)

Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.



Local tours are the most popular option for the upcoming Qingming Festival holiday on April 3-5, as travelers have shortened the radius of their travel to reduce risk amid the pandemic, business insiders said.

(51) _____

From the presale of train tickets, as of March 28, the proportion of intraprovincial passengers accounted for 75 percent of the national total, an increase of more than 20 percent compared with the same period last year.

“Since the outbreak of the pandemic, leisure travel to suburbs and rural areas are in demand among tourists,” a manager of Qunar was quoted as saying by *Beijing Daily*.

“The increasing demand energizes accommodation in rural areas, with some having outperformed hotels in downtown areas.”

Moreover, during this year’s (Qingming Festival), some upscale hotels and homestays in rural areas have cut their prices by about 30 percent, attracting many, tourists to choose countryside travel, the manager said. According to the tourism platform, some hotel reservations in rural areas doubled year-on-year, with the price half of that from the Spring Festival in February. (52) _____.

“We had to cancel our travel plans to stay in Beijing due to the outbreak across the country. I plan to take my family on a two-night trip in the suburbs and travel around,” a visitor surnamed Zhao told *Beijing Business Today*.

Enjoying the tourist boom, homestays in Beijing’s suburbs have witnessed increasing reservations.

The number of guests will be doubled during the holiday, an owner of a homestay in the capital’s Yanqing district was quoted as saying by *Beijing Business Today*.

(53) _____

According to travel service and social networking platform Mafengwo, keywords such as “flower appreciation”, “camping” and “cycling” are key search items.

Sales of tickets to some public parks and holiday resorts accounted for nearly 80 percent of

the total tourist attractions, data from Qunar showed.

The surge in local tours presents opportunities for the homestay and hospitality industry, which can tackle the industry's lackluster performance due to the effects of the pandemic, business insiders said.

The report on tourism operations of 2021 and development forecast of 2022 released by China Tourism Academy pointed out that, for 2022, the pandemic will remain the biggest uncertain factor affecting tourism sector's recovery. (54) ____



Due to the pandemic, local tours are the main traveling mode currently, said Wang Xingbin, a tourism expert told *Beijing Business Today*.

Wang said it requires more observation for how the tourism industry enters recovery.

"Affected by the pandemic, the tourism industry becomes vulnerable and requires support," Wang said. (55) ____

Questions 51-55

Choose from the sentences A-G the one which best fits each gap of 51-55. There are two extra sentences which you do not need to use.

- | |
|---|
| <p>A. With flowers in full bloom in the springtime and temperatures rising, people are eager to enjoy outdoor activities.</p> <p>B. He added that the tourism industry is expected to suffer from a relatively long period of difficulties under the pandemic.</p> <p>C. Holiday makers choose short trips amid outbreak of virus and rural homestays benefit as people stay closer to home for, Qingming Festival.</p> <p>D. Cities including Dali, Chengdu, Lijiang, Chongqing, Beijing, Guangzhou and Sanya are among the favorite destinations.</p> <p>E. Data from online travel agency Qunar show that. suburb tour reservations for this year's holiday increased by 30 percent year-on-year.</p> <p>F. Tourists go sailing in boats or take photos in an oilseed rape field of blooms: to enjoy springtime.</p> <p>G. But with innovation, the supply for high-quality cultural products and tourism services will be further enhanced.</p> |
|---|

Section B (10 marks)

Questions 56 to 60 are based on the following passage.

A high-rise apartment block can be defined as a building which has a large number of storeys and is equipped with elevators. It is generally 35 metres or greater in height. Because of expanding population and the lack of space for building new houses high-rise apartment blocks have become increasingly common in most of the world's major cities and towns. However, some people say that residents in multi-storey building do not really enjoy living in them. It is claimed that they feel isolated, are often lonely and live in such blocks not by choice but out of necessity. This is misconception. There are, in fact, many benefits of living in this type of accommodation and few disadvantages. Most people enjoy this style of living and do not crave for a house or low-level apartment.

The most significant advantage of choosing to live in a high-rise building is that the residents are close to most things they need for their everyday living. High-rise apartments tend to be in desirable, urban locations, near to the downtown area. As a result, residents have quick and easy access to shopping, nightlife, cultural institutions, transport facilities and often their place of work. However, there are also high-rise apartments situated in beautiful, natural surroundings, such as parks, gardens and beach areas. These are generally outside the city centre and they will be chosen by people looking for an alternative to city life.

A great advantage of high-rise apartments is that they are generally cheaper to buy than a house. They are also cheaper for living and maintenance. Buying an apartment typically costs from \$200,000-300,000 but buying a house will cost a lot more. Maintenance costs are undoubtedly cheaper for high-rise apartments because the surface area of high-rise apartments is smaller than the surface area of houses. Also, living and maintaining a house is generally a lot more time-consuming. A great argument, too, is that living above the ground in an apartment is more peaceful and less noisy than living in a house.

Another major advantage of high-rise accommodation is that it offers a wide range of shared amenities such as: doormen, controlled entry, fitness centres, swimming pools, recreation areas, morning coffee sessions and hosted events aimed at bringing residents together. These provide opportunities for residents to get to know each other better. They develop a sense of community, which helps residents to avoid feeling of isolation and loneliness. The residents look out for each other, so that a sense of safety and security is fostered.



Critics of high-rise apartments point out that there are limited opportunities for gardening in such buildings. This is not entirely true since many residents have balconies and they can use these to grow vegetables, plants and flowers. More importantly, there is a tendency nowadays for architects to design high-rise buildings which include “green” spaces for trees, plants and shrubs. A high-rise building in Milan, Italy trees, “BoscoVertical” is typical of this trend. It will provide hundreds of new homes and bring a hectare of forest into the city’s central

business district. This building will be a perfect model for architects designing tower blocks in the future.

To sum up, there are unquestionably many advantages of living in high-rise apartment buildings. Rather than creating feelings of isolation and loneliness, these buildings develop a sense of community and for many people they offer an ideal lifestyle. Such apartments will undoubtedly increase in the future because of the population growth and lack of space in many countries.

Questions 56 to 60

Answer the following questions with the information given in the passage.

56. Why are there so many high-rise apartment blocks in big cities and towns nowadays?
57. Where are high-rise apartments also situated?
58. Say one advantage of high-rise accommodation offering shared amenities for residents.
59. What is the tendency for architects to design high-rise buildings?
60. What will “BoscoVertical” be for architects designing high-rises in the future?

Section C (10 marks)

Questions 61 to 65 are based on the following passage.

Laura was in her mid-20s when she had a heart attack. During the attack, because there was not enough oxygen, her brain and body were badly damaged. After the attack, she could hardly move her body or communicate with the people around her. Many treatments were tried by the medical staff, but none seemed to work. One of the staff asked Laura's family what her favourite songs were. Then he tried singing one to her it was a Boyzone song called "No Matter What". He noticed a change in her right away, and felt she

was _____ listening to the song. During the following weeks her lips began to move more and more, and her general level of response improved. Her responses showed that there was still someone inside Laura's body and that she was very much alive.

This story and many others like it show how music has been used to help people with a variety of problems. These problems can be physical difficulties, special needs, depression, brain damage or personality disorders. People also use music to relieve stress. They may put on their favourite piece of music when they arrive home after a stressful day. This use of music to heal or help people is music therapy.

At some very deep level, human beings have a connection with music. It can change our mood and affect our emotions. This is not surprising, because for centuries music has existed in human civilization and exists in some way or other in all cultures. According to some studies, six-month-old babies respond more to their mothers when they sing compared to when they talk. In some ways, the human body itself can be seen as a musical instrument—we can clap, stamp and sing.



The heartbeat can be compared to the beat of a drum and even our breathing has a certain rhythm: to it. We also have strong associations with different songs or types of music. For example, many couples have "their song" which may remind them of some happy time in the past. Music therapy uses this deep human response to music to treat people. Therapists have to be very

skilled musicians who are able to improvise and match the music to each patient. Naturally, patients participate as much as possible in the making of the music. If they are able to play, patients can choose different instruments from drums to maracas or the piano and use them to develop their own musical expression. Of course, using your own voice is fine too! Experiencing music together and developing a relationship between therapist and patient are important parts of the treatment.

Although science has yet to prove precisely how music therapy works, there is no doubt that it does work. There are many case studies such as the one at the beginning of this essay which support this, and the fact that music therapy has existed for over 2,000 years points to its enduring usefulness. In addition, it has been acknowledged and used by many organizations from hospitals to prisons. The World Federation of Music Therapy was founded in 1985 to help further its development and promote its use. Music therapy is also being acknowledged in higher education. Michigan State University is planning to launch its own music therapy degree programme to train

future music therapists the first of its kind in the world. Whether you are a stressed executive, suffer from depression or have a medical condition, there is no doubt that music therapy can offer you a solution. In this day and age, people are increasingly focused on their own well-being and have a number of different methods they can use. These might include exercise, yoga and various alternative healing methods such as herbal remedies, reflexology, or massage. With its long history and proven effectiveness, music therapy represents a powerful additional method we can use to benefit our lives and those around us.



Questions 61 to 65

Complete the summary below with information from the passage, using no more than three words for each blank.

Laura was 25 when she had a heart attack. The staff member sang her favourite song and she responded to the song. Most of us recognize that music has a big impact on our well-being. But not so many people realize that the (61) _____ we have to music can be used as a treatment for people with different illnesses and (62) _____, such as depression. People also use music to relieve stress. We may (63) _____ our favourite piece of music when we arrive home after a stressful day. Whether we are playing an instrument, singing or (64) _____, music is something that has an enormous beneficial (65) _____ on our lives.

Part V Translation (15 marks)

Section A (5 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into Chinese. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

66. The youth generation is a major force in addressing climate change, and also a force representing the future. Youths from all walks of life are taking actions to address climate change and protect biodiversity wherever they are in the world. At this critical juncture where history is about to be made, we embrace a shared vision-to build a future where man and nature share a community of life and a beautiful world where all life coexists in harmony. To this end, as the young generation, we declare that: be better implementors; be better sharers; be better researchers; be better promoters.

Section B (10 marks)

Translate the following paragraph into English. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

67. 坚持严格的纯素食饮食 (vegan diet) 或许听起来很难, 尤其是在许多常见的菜肴都含有肉或者其他非素食的情况下。但近年来, 纯素食主义成为了全球增长趋势最快的一种生活方式。为何纯素食主义如此受欢迎? 原因之一或许是人们想要保护环境。众所周知, 生产肉类和奶制品会给环境带来很大压力。另一个原因在于, 如今不少年轻人都认为宰杀动物为食是错误的。纯素食主义对于许多人而言仅仅意味着不吃肉、奶酪或鸡蛋, 但采取无动物成分的做法同样适用于时尚业和制造业。例如皮革被用来制作鞋履和衣服, 如今, 许多品牌在寻找其他材料作为替代。

Part VI IQ Test (10 marks)

There are five IQ Test questions in this part. Write the answers on the **answer sheet**.

68. If I jump into water, what will I become?

69. What goes up when rain comes down?

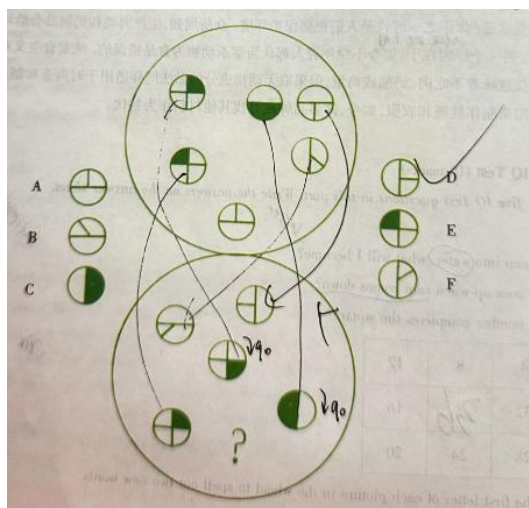
70. What number completes the square?

4	8	12
32		16
28	24	20

71. Put the first letter of each picture in the wheel to spell out two new words.



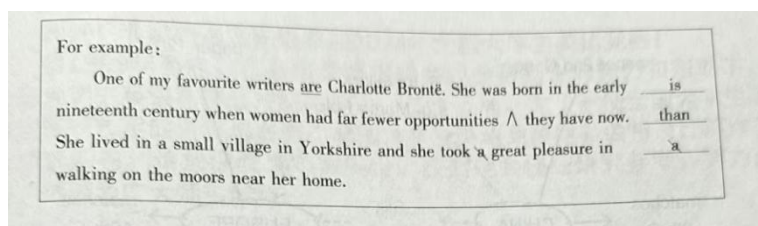
72. Which of the circles, A, B, C, D, E, or F, should replace the question mark in the bottom large circle?



Part VII Error Correction (10 marks)

Proofread the passage as required. Each indicated line contains a maximum of one error. Correct the passage in the following way: for a right line, put the sign “√” in the corresponding blank; for a wrong word, underline the wrong word and write the correct one in the blank; for a missing word, mark the position of the missing word with the sign “增添符” and write the word you believe to be missing in the blank; for an unnecessary word, cross the unnecessary word with the sign “划去” and put the word with the sign “划去” in the blank. Write the answers on the answer sheet.

排的时候可以按图里面这个修改，加那种斜线什么的，改完把图和这段文字删除即可



For example :

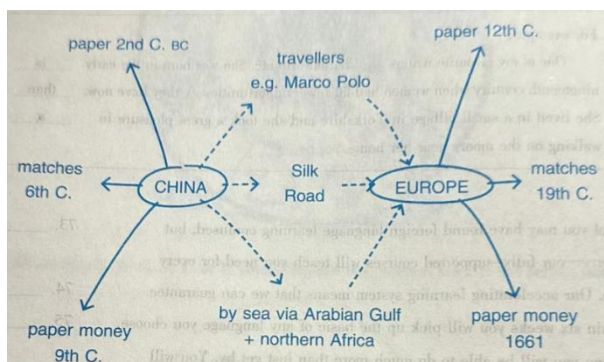
One of my favourite writers are Charlotte Bronte. She was born in the early is nineteenth century when women had far fewer opportunities 增添符 they have now. than She lived in a small village in Yorkshire and she took a great pleasure in a walking on the moors near her home

At school you may have found foreign language learning confused, but 73. ____
 don't worry our fully-supported courses will teach you need for every
 situation. Our accelerating learning system means that we can guarantee 74. ____
 that within six weeks you will pick up the basic of any language you choose. 75. ____
 Pretty soon you will be able to do much more than just get by. You will
 become fluent and able to hold intelligence conversations with native 76. ____
 speakers. Soon your language level will really take off as you begin to
 master language. All aspects of the language are covered- reading and 77. ____
 listening, grammar and vocabulary, development and pronounce work 78. ____
 to perfect your accent. An online tutor and workbook will answer your
 grammar questions, and there are also regularly tests as part of the course. 79. ____
 Slow to catch on? Not with our special system which is designed for with 80. ____
 the non-language learner in mind. We offer a series of online resources and
 apps for mobile learning, together with a writing skills support package.
 Extensive notes in English make learning easy and faster. Now, more than 81. ____
 ever is the time to take up a new language. It will open up a new world for you
 so help you keep up with the bilingual high flyers. This is an investment 82. ____
 which will pay off immediately and for the rest of your life.

Part VII Writing (30 marks)

Section A (10 marks)

83. The following notes are about the comparison between several ancient Chinese inventions and European inventions, as well as the transmission routes of the Chinese inventions. Please write a report based on the notes.



*Write the report in at least **120 words** on the **answer sheet**.*

Section B (20 marks)

84. Write about the following topic.

Some people believe that you should work hard today to prepare for the future, while others believe in the philosophy that “tomorrow never comes”, so you should enjoy your life to the fullest today. Discuss the advantages of each of these philosophies. Then indicate which one you believe in and why.

*Write an article of at least **180 words** in an appropriate style on the **answer sheet**.*